

— EDITION 16

The De-Funding of Cross-Border Monopolies

SWIFT handles \$150 Trillion a year. But its monopoly is facing an existential cross-border squeeze from three sides.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

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The Cracks in the Global Cross-Border Standard.

For decades, international banking has depended entirely on the SWIFT messaging network. But passing text messages across multiple intermediate correspondent banks creates systemic delay and friction.

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Pressure Point 1: Interconnected Real- Time Domestic Rails.

Countries are bypassing traditional correspondent networks entirely by linking their domestic real-time settlement systems (like Brazil's Pix and India's UPI) directly to one another.

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Pressure Point 2: Corporate Stablecoin Corridors.

Global enterprises are increasingly opting out of multi-day wire transfers, routing high-value international liquidity corridors over tokenized public ledgers in seconds for nominal fees.

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Pressure Point 3: AI Orchestration Bypassing Banks.

Autonomous payment routers can dynamically split and route international value across diverse fintech paths, avoiding traditional bottleneck banking hubs entirely.

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SWIFT's Counter-Offensive.

Recognizing the threat, SWIFT is rushing to pilot digital asset sandboxes and real-time ledger connections, trying to morph their messaging protocol into an orchestrator for the modern web.

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The Winner of the New Global Liquidity Superhighway.

The future of cross-border value movement will not be dominated by a single closed consortium, but by open, highly programmable networks that settle transactions at the speed of software.

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Save This: The 3-Front Squeeze on SWIFT.

1) Domestic real-time rails linking directly (Pix↔UPI) bypass correspondents. 2) Corporate stablecoin corridors settle in seconds for nominal fees. 3) AI orchestration splits value across paths, dodging hub banks. SWIFT's counter: digital asset pilots. The likely winner: *open, programmable networks*.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Does SWIFT survive?

Comment your verdict — adaptation or fax machine. Repost to share it, and follow for daily agentic payments breakdowns.

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